



Best router for gamers?

The WRT32X router from Linksys comes with a feature that prioritises gaming data over everything else. <http://digit.in/WRT32Xug>



ShadowPlay update for PUBG

NVIDIA's ShadowPlay Highlights now captures your chicken dinners and best moments automatically on PUBG. <http://digit.in/PUBGnvidia>



Autonomous cars are far away

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utonomous cars have been the favourite child of automobile companies and silicon valley tech giants for

a while now. Even though this dream might have been in the making for some time, the last few years have seen a lot of chatter surrounding it, with the first batch tests on public streets getting the go-ahead earlier this year in a few first world countries. Since then, everyone and their uncle seems to be claiming that a driverless future is right around the corner. That might have been true, if the corner was not actually a mile wide and ridden with potholes, jaywalkers and bird shit along the way.

It is not news that autonomous cars are not perfect. But what bothers us is the state in which it is right now and how it is being portrayed. Some of the problems that can throw an autonomous car off track are extremely common and happen every day. For instance, there are numerous issues that pop-up when you completely remove the human element out of the car. Take a busy intersection at a highway, where traffic is present from all directions at

We're too far away from a driverless future

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any given time. Now, when a signal to turn right is given, an autonomous car won't be able to make eye-contact with a trailing human driver from the opposite lane to judge whether it should make the turn before he passes or after. A lack of perception when it comes to intention has already led to accidents in autonomous car testing.

AUTONOMOUS CARS CAN'T BE PRICKS AND THAT'S A PROBLEM

Sometimes, hand signals from traffic police/managing authorities form a crucial part of navigating the roads. If the situation is especially chaotic, a human driver can look to the traffic police for guidance to make sure they don't contribute to the chaos and can make their way out of it peacefully. On the other hand, an autonomous car, even if it does have the technical ability to understand hand signals, might not be able to accommodate for the human

variation in the same signal being made by different people. That is, if it can even make the judgement call to put traffic rules aside and follow the human navigator. While Google had announced that its autonomous car can recognise a hand signal from a cyclist, a four-way traffic jam is a completely different ball-game. Additionally, as George Filip at the University of Nottingham, UK puts it, giving cyclists and pedestrians the ability to stop autonomous cars could end up making cities gridlocked. Who ever thought that overly polite autonomous vehicles would end up being a problem?

THE TROLLEY PROBLEM

It is established that putting autonomous vehicles on the road would lead to a certain percentage of reduction in road accidents. But this gives rise to a new issue - how will the vehicle deal with the ones that do happen? This brings us, and the automobile industry, to the trolley problem.

A thought experiment in ethics, in its most simple form the trolley problem is as follows:

There is a runaway trolley barrelling down the railway tracks. Ahead, on the